Student Field Guide: Single-Spot Sidewalk Assessments

Open the assessment tool: https://achikicoa.github.io/SidewalkAssessmentTool/

Use **Point Inspection** to document one specific sidewalk problem at a time, such as a raised slab, crack, gap, obstruction, or curb ramp issue. For this test, do not use Recorder Mode.

Field test: Point Issue reports are preferred. Recorder Mode is disabled in the app during this test because its walking GPS path is not reliable enough. For the cleanest test, select Point Issue and record each problem as a separate point. Confirm its location on the map and include nearby landmarks in your comments. Sidewalk Segment remains available for a long continuous problem when your instructor specifically asks you to use it.

Before You Start

- Open the project website provided by your instructor on your phone.

- Allow location access when asked. Bring a charged phone and a ruler or tape measure. Measure slopes only if you have appropriate equipment.

- Stay on safe public walking routes. Do not step into traffic or enter private property to obtain a measurement or photograph.

- Submit one practice report with your instructor before starting fieldwork. Have the instructor confirm that the report and photos arrived.

Submit a Report

1. **Choose the location.** Select **Point Inspection** and keep **Report Type** set to **Point Issue** unless your instructor directs you to report a long continuous stretch. Tap **Use My Location**. Check the map against your surroundings. Move the map so the center target is over the actual issue, then tap **Confirm Point**. Tap **Next: Photos**.

2. **Take photos.** Take a close photo showing the defect and a wider photo showing where it is. Include a ruler in the close photo when useful. Check the previews, then tap **Next: Condition**. Avoid including identifiable people or vehicle plates where practical.

3. **Describe the condition.** Choose all issue types that apply at this spot. A quick preset can help, but check its selections. For a long continuous problem, use **Long Bad Section** only if your instructor requests a Sidewalk Segment report. Choose severity using the definitions below. Tap **Next: Context**.

4. **Add context and comments.** Select pedestrian volume and school/bus-stop proximity. Choose **Unknown** for proximity if unsure. In comments, describe the street side, nearest address or landmark, and the problem. Example: “North side of Main Street, beside the library entrance; raised edge between two slabs.” Tap **Next: Measurements**.

5. **Enter measurements you actually took.** Relevant measurement fields appear based on the issue type. Vertical displacement and gap width use inches; passable width uses feet; slopes use percent. For reference, .25 inch is 1/4 inch, .5 inch is 1/2 inch, and .75 inch is 3/4 inch. Leave unmeasured fields blank or set to **Not measured**. Do not enter zero to mean unknown. Tap **Skip/Next: Contact**.

6. **Enter your contact information.** Use the name and email your instructor asks you to use. Check any information filled in from an earlier report. Tap **Review Report**.

7. **Review and submit.** Check the location, issue types, severity, measurements, and photos. Tap **Submit Report** once and read the result. Keep the Report ID for your field notes. If an error or pending-upload message appears, tell your instructor; do not assume it reached the database.

8. **Continue to another spot.** Choose **Start Another Nearby** or **Start New Report**. Nearby reports can retain context from the previous report, so check it and confirm the new location every time.

Severity and Context

Field	Meaning
Fair	Usable, with a minor defect or early wear.
Poor	A clear defect makes walking or access more difficult.
Severe	A major barrier, trip hazard, or blocked path.
Missing	The sidewalk, curb ramp, or connection is absent.
Low pedestrian volume	Occasional pedestrian use.
Medium pedestrian volume	Regular use during part of the day.
High pedestrian volume	Frequent use or a busy pedestrian destination.

Use a consistent judgment across your team. These are field observations, not a final engineering or legal accessibility determination.

Current Limitations and Testing Notes

- **Phone GPS is approximate.** Buildings, trees, and other conditions can shift the location. Confirm the target visually and include a useful landmark in comments. The accuracy number is an estimate, not a guarantee.

- **The tool does not measure defects for you.** Photos, GPS, and scores do not replace a ruler, slope measurement, or professional assessment.

- **Uploads depend on connectivity and backend configuration.** A locally saved report is not proof that it arrived in Google Sheets or ArcGIS. Keep the same phone/browser and do not clear browser data while reports may be pending. Ask your instructor to check received reports during the test.

- **Scores are preliminary.** Treat the GIS score and priority as screening aids, not final repair decisions or compliance findings.

- **This guide matches the repository's current interface.** The deployed website may differ if it has not been updated. Report missing buttons or different steps to your instructor.

- **This guide is not a live-system certification.** Confirm a practice report and its photos arrive before collecting a large batch.

Feedback to Bring Back

Record the Report ID, phone/browser used, what you tried, what happened, and what you expected. Note confusing wording, difficult buttons, incorrect locations, missing photos, and submission failures. Screenshots are helpful when safe to take. If an upload is uncertain, check with your instructor before resubmitting to avoid duplicates.